A-A-1668C
December 1, 1987
SUPERSEDING
A-A-1668B
April 8, 1986

# COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

## BAG, PLASTIC, GENERAL PURPOSE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This description covers general purpose plastic bags. These bags are used primarily as garbage bags and as liners for office trash cans and outdoor trash cans.

SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS:

1. Style: The bags shall be furnished in the style specified in the contract. If no style is specified, any style of commercially available plastic trash bag is acceptable, provided that the bags meet all the requirements of this commercial item description. The bags shall be furnished in the duty rating, color, and quantity per box specified in the contract.

2. Dimensions: The bags shall be furnished with inside dimensions not less than those specified in the contract. Length shall be measured half way between the sides of the fully extended bag; width shall be measured half way between the top and bottom of the fully extended bag. Dimensional tolerances for an individual bag shall be plus 10% or minus 0%.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: APPROVED FOR PUBLIC RELEASE; DISTRIBUTION IS UNLIMITED.

FSC 8105

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3. Physical Properties. The bags shall have the physical properties specified in Table I, below:

Table I. Physical Properties

| Characteristic | Requirement | | | Test Method |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Light Duty | Medium Duty | Heavy Duty | |
| Impact Resistance, (DART), grams | 75, min. | 100, min. | 165, min. | SEE PAGE 3 |
| Tearing Resistance | | | | SEE PAGE 3 |
| Perpendicular to the length of the bag, grams | ------ | 240, min. | 480, min. | |
| Parallel to the length of the bag, grams | ------ | 240, min. | 480, min. | |
| Load Capacity, pounds, | As Specified in the contract | As Specified in the contract | As Specified in the contract | SEE PAGE 3 |
| Seam Continuity, seconds, | 60, min. | 60, min. | 60, min. | SEE PAGE 4 |



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4. Impact Resistance Test: Impact resistance shall be determined as specified by method A Section 13.1 of ASTM D 1709, except that no more than three failures shall be acceptable. Ten bags from each sample unit shall be tested at the dart weight specified in Table I. If more than three bags fail that sample unit shall be rejected.

5. Tearing Resistance Test: Tearing resistance shall be determined as specified in ASTM D 1922. Constant radius specimens shall be used. Thickness measurements are not applicable.

6. Load Capacity Tests:

The solid waste load capacity test shall be performed on one previously untested bag from each sample unit. A group of paper backed books and/or magazines weighing 0.5 - 4.0 pounds each whose total weight equals that of the test load specified in the contract shall constitute the test load for Light Duty bags. A group of full metal food cans weighing 1.0 - 2.0 pounds each whose total weight equals that of the test load specified in the contract shall constitute the test load for Medium Duty and Heavy Duty bags.

When specified in the contract, the liquid waste load capacity test shall be performed in addition to the solid waste load capacity test. One previously untested bag from each sample unit shall be tested. A volume of water at $70^{\circ} \pm 5^{\circ}$ F ($21^{\circ} \pm 3^{\circ}$C) whose weight equals that of the test load specified in the contract shall constitute the test load. (Water at $70^{\circ}$ F weighs 8.33 pounds per gallon).

The bag may be placed in a clean container with smooth sides while adding the test load. After adding the test load, the bag shall be grasped or clamped within 12 inches of the top, removed from the container (if used), and raised by hand or mechanical means until the bottom of the bag is not less than 12 inches from the floor. The bag shall be held in this position for 60 seconds. Any spillage or leakage of the test load constitutes failure of the test. Any tear in the bag more than 1 inch long constitutes failure of the test.



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7. Seam Continuity Test: The seam continuity test shall be performed on one previously untested bag from each sample unit except that Light Duty and Medium Duty bags for which the liquid waste load capacity test is specified by the contract shall not be subjected to the seam continuity test. The bag may be placed in a clean container with smooth sides while adding the water. For Light Duty and Medium Duty bags, water at $70^{\circ} \pm 5^{\circ}$ F weighing 50 ± 1% of the test load specified in the contract shall be added to the bag. For Heavy Duty bags, water at $120^{\circ} \pm 5^{\circ}$ F ($49^{\circ} \pm 3^{\circ}$ C) weighing 50 ± 1% of the test load specified in the contract shall be added to the bag. (Water at $120^{\circ}$ F weighs 8.24 pounds per gallon). The bag shall be grasped or clamped within 12 inches of the top, removed from the container (if used) and raised by hand or mechanical means until the bottom of the bag is not less than 12 inches from the floor. The bag shall be held in this position for 60 seconds. Any leakage constitutes failure of the test.

8. Workmanship: The bags shall be uniformly made, free from pinholes, tears, cuts, creases, wrinkles, extraneous matter or other defects which may impair their serviceability or appearance.

QUALITY ASSURANCE:

Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspections and tests. The Government reserves the right to perform any, or all, of these inspections and tests it deems necessary to assure conformance of the product and adequacy of the contractor's inspections and tests. Each lot of bags shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements specified herein. For inspection purposes, a lot shall consist of bags of one size, style, color and duty rating, manufactured under the same conditions and at the same time. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105D and Change Notice 2 dated 20 March 1964, as described below:

1. Visual and Dimensional Characteristics: Inspection level S-3, Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one bag.



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2. Physical Properties and Tests: Inspection level S-2, Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 1.5 percent defective. The sample unit and lot size shall be units of issue. Sufficient numbers of specimens necessary to conduct the specified tests must be selected from each sample unit.

3. Packaging, packing, marking and palletization: Inspection level S-2, Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The bags shall be inspected for conformance to the packaging, packing, marking and palletization requirements specified below and in the contract. The sample units and lot sizes shall be shipping containers and pallets separately. The lot sizes shall be the number of sample units in the lots.

PACKAGING AND PACKING:

The specified quantity of bags with a like number of ties, when ordered, shall be packaged in a close-fitting fiberboard box and packed to assure acceptance by common carrier and to provide product protection against loss or damage during multiple shipments, handling and storage. The shipping container shall be in compliance with the National Freight Classification and the Uniform Freight Classification. The specified number of bags per box shall be the minimum acceptable quantity.

MARKING:

Marking shall be as specified in the contract.

PALLETIZATION:

Palletization shall be as specified in the contract.

NOTES:

Users of this commercial item description shall specify the dimensions, duty rating, color, quantity per box, whether ties are required with the bags, and when the bags must be tested by the liquid waste load capacity test. If a style other than that described herein is required, the style (flat, gusseted, C-fold, etc.) shall be specified.



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Contracts for bags intended to contain infectious waste or other hazardous liquid contents should require the bags to be tested by the liquid waste load capacity test. It is recommended that for such applications, double bagging be utilized.

The commercial item certification clause is not required when this Commercial Item Description is used for procurement.

The issue of the ASTM Standard Test Methods in effect on the date of the solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with the requirements of Table I. ASTM Methods are available from:

American Society for Testing and Materials
1916 Race Street
Philadelphia, PA 19103.

MIL-STD-105D and Change Notice 2 is available from:

Naval Publications and Forms Center
5801 Tabor Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19120

Military custodians:

No official DOD interest has been registered for this item.

Preparing activity:

GSA - FSS



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